

August 20, 2026

South Carolina Medicaid (Healthy Connections / SCDHHS)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Twanda Rippin (MRN MUSC5789896), Claim MUSC-B85D-1

Patient	Twanda Rippin (DOB 1973-01-28)
MRN	MUSC5789896
Member ID / Group	SCD540309134 / GRP-17900
Claim number	MUSC-B85D-1
Date of service	2026-07-08
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	D64.9 — Anemia, unspecified
Denied amount	\$407.10
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-09-03

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of patient Twanda Rippin (MRN: MUSC5789896, Member ID: SCD540309134) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-B85D-1, covering services rendered on July 8, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. The claim was denied on August 4, 2026, under CARC 16 and RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and asserts that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier (NPI) was valid and present on the original claim submission.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Rippin is a 53-year-old established female patient with active diagnoses of anemia, unspecified (D64.9), and chronic sinusitis (J06.9), both of which served as the basis for the July 8, 2026, outpatient encounter. Her anemia has been an active, documented condition since February 2017, and she has an ongoing treatment history that includes Vitamin B12 injectable solution. She is also being managed for prediabetes. The visit was billed as CPT 99214, an office or outpatient visit for an established patient requiring moderate-complexity medical decision-making, rendered by Dr. Elena V. Castellanos, MD, at place of service 22 (on-campus outpatient hospital). The billed amount was \$407.10. The clinical appropriateness of the visit and the accuracy of the procedure and diagnosis codes are not in dispute; the sole stated basis for denial is an administrative data element issue.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial under RARC N290 indicates that the rendering provider's primary identifier — the NPI — was considered missing, incomplete, or invalid. MUSC Health maintains that Dr. Elena V. Castellanos, MD, holds a valid and active NPI (1881726354) and that this identifier was included on the claim as submitted on July 12, 2026. Under HIPAA administrative simplification standards and South Carolina Medicaid billing requirements, the NPI is the required primary identifier for rendering providers on professional and institutional claims, and Dr. Castellanos's NPI satisfies that requirement.

To the extent that a technical submission error caused the NPI to appear absent or unreadable during adjudication, this appeal serves as the vehicle to correct that administrative deficiency. South Carolina Medicaid's appeal and resubmission processes expressly permit correction of claim submission errors of this nature. The denial does not reflect any finding that the services were not medically necessary, not covered under the plan, or improperly coded. The allowed amount of \$280.71 already established by the payer confirms that the service itself was recognized as a covered benefit; the sole impediment to payment is the unresolved provider identifier question, which this appeal directly addresses.

MUSC Health respectfully requests that South Carolina Medicaid treat this appeal as a corrected claim submission with the rendering provider NPI 1881726354 explicitly reaffirmed, and that the claim be reprocessed accordingly. All other claim data elements — including the member ID, date of service, place of service, procedure code, diagnosis codes, and billed charges — remain as originally submitted and are accurate.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health requests that South Carolina Medicaid (Healthy Connections / SCDHHS) reopen and reprocess Claim MUSC-B85D-1 using the confirmed rendering provider NPI 1881726354 for Dr. Elena V. Castellanos, MD, and issue payment at the applicable Medicaid allowed amount for CPT 99214 rendered on July 8, 2026. Should the payer require a formal corrected claim submission in addition to this appeal, MUSC Health is prepared to submit one immediately upon request. We ask that this matter be resolved within the timeframe required under South Carolina Medicaid's prompt-pay obligations and that written confirmation of the adjudication outcome be provided to MUSC Health's Revenue Cycle department.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)

- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record